Powassan & District Union Public Library

Minutes for Monday, March 16, 2026 – 6:15 p.m.

Board Meeting @ Library

In-person: Debbie Piper, Will Armstrong, Bill Finnis, Steve Kirkey, Pat Stephens, Larry Woodword, Marie Rosset

Via Zoom: Valerie Morgan, Bernadette Kerr

Absent with regrets: Randy Hall, Jennie Leblond

Recording of meeting

Item	Action	Responsibility
1. Call to order	6:15 pm	
2. Respect and Acknowledgement Declaration	Declaration read by CEO We respectfully acknowledge that we are on the traditional territory of the Anishinaabe Peoples, in the Robinson-Huron and Williams Treaties areas. We wish to acknowledge the long history of First Nations and Métis Peoples in Ontario and show respect to the neighbouring Indigenous communities. We offer our gratitude for their care for, and teachings about, our earth and our relations. May we continue to honour these teachings and recognize their value going forward.	
3. General Consent Motion: Presented the general Consent Motion for March 2026, which includes: a) Approval of the March 16, 2026 Agenda, b) Approval of Minutes from the February 23, 2026 meeting, c) Approval of the February 2026 Financial Statements.	CEO presented information to the Board Yearly Program Attendance 2016: 8,645 2025: 11,737 2025 In-Person Visits: 28,494 Which means that in 2025 41% of visitors to the library were there for some sort of programming. **Motion: 2026-07** **That the General Consent Motion for March 2026 be adopted with modified agenda.** **Moved by**: Pat Stephens **Seconded by**: Larry Woodward Carried.	
4. Disclosure of pecuniary Interest	None	
5. Business a) Update on hiring of new CEO	Ads for the CEO position were posted at the beginning of March and several applications have	Hiring Committee

	been submitted. Jen Leblond from the hiring committee is drafting interview questions.	
b) Grants update	• PDUPL applied for the **2026 OTF Capital Grant** to repair and bring up to code their elevator through the Township of Nipissing. Kim Turnbull, from Nipissing worked with CEO to complete application. • **Seniors Community Grant** application – pending • **Canada Summer Job** (CSJ) – pending • **Art Council of Ontario** – application for funding for the August Music Festival submitted Feb 18. • CEO complimented Kim Turnbull for her competency and suggested using more of her services in the future – dependent on her availability.	
c) Library Agreement Renewal Update	No new development shared. CEO to send interim invoices to Union Members who haven't paid their Library Fees.	Councillor Hall
d) Photocopying Contract with Xerox	Digital Office Solutions (DOS) is no longer an Authorized Agency with Xerox Canada. Document Xcellence has taken over the contract. Their representative has informed us that through the Vendor of Record (VOR) Ontario program, printing costs will be reduced substantially. Will Armstrong recommended to register the Library as a VOR recipient. CEO will investigate	CEO
e) Upcoming Activities	Same as last months: March Break Activities, CEO distributed handout describing activities. March 16: St Pats activities March 17: Silent Dance Party in partnership with 250 GAP program March 18: Skate Event March 19: Steven Morrin – wild animal Presentation March 20: Mini Olympics April 7: special presentation on local Hospice care April 28: presentation of MAiD with Dr. Gauthier	

6. Correspondence	none	
7. Committee Reports		
a) Property Committee	- OTF Capital Grant submitted. All elevator repairs delayed until results from application received.	CEO
b) Financial Committee	- The Budget was sent out to three municipalities – approval pending. - Audit by BakerTilly is completed, final report will be presented at the April 20, meeting. - New contract with Xerox could potentially save $1,300 per year.	BakerTilly CEO
c) Policy Committee	- SERV-07 PDUPL Facility Use Policy Scheduling and fees modified **Motion: 2026-08** **That SERV-07 PDUPL Facility Use Policy be adopted as modified.** **Moved by:** Stephen Kirkey **Seconded by**: Will Armstrong **Carried.** - RES-20 Artificial (AI) Policy and Generative Artificial Intelligence (GenAI) policy deferred until we have more information	
d) Friends of the Library	- Friends agreed to cover the cost of shelving and fireplace surround in Enever Room - Will cover cost of a kitchen update. - Home Hardware will supply materials and fixtures.	CEO and friends
8. Adjournment	**Motion: 2026-09** That the March 16, 2026, meeting be adjourned at 7:15 pm. **Moved by**: Bill Finnis	Next meeting: April 20, 2026, at 6:15 pm

Vice Chair: Pat Stephens
Debbie Piper

Recorder: _____
Marie Rosset, CEO